PART D | EXECUTIVE RECOMMENDATION

Re-scope the Programme, Not the Ambition

Five Azure DevOps organisations, ~1,000 repositories and ~1,500 pipelines. Repository migration is ahead of plan; pipeline conversion is behind. Security wants stronger enforcement, some legacy products cannot use standard runners, metric quality is disputed, and developers report added friction.

RECOMMENDATION	**Re-scope: continue repository migration, replace pipeline-by-pipeline conversion with a reusable golden path, enforce controls on all new work now, and gate full funding on Day-90 evidence.**	Not **accelerate**. Not **pause**.

Why re-scope rather than accelerate or pause

The six signals point in different directions, which is exactly why the two obvious choices are wrong. Accelerating spreads a proven migration method onto an unproven pipeline method and a disputed measurement system. Pausing stops the one part that is working and leaves 1,500 uncontrolled pipelines ageing in place. Re-scoping keeps the momentum that exists and rebuilds the two parts that do not work.

Option	What actually happens	Verdict
Accelerate	Repository migration continues at pace, but pipeline conversion still progresses one pipeline at a time. Duplication is preserved at 1,500x cost, security enforcement is deferred again, and the disputed metric estate is scaled rather than fixed.	**Reject** - scales the defect, not the fix.
Pause	The proven repository work stops. Teams keep shipping on inconsistent pipelines, friction is unchanged, and the estate keeps growing while decisions wait. Restart cost and credibility loss are both high.	**Reject** - stops the only thing working.
Re-scope	Repository migration continues. Pipeline conversion is replaced by a golden path plus a migration factory. Controls apply to all new work immediately, with a dated backlog for the existing estate. Funding for the full estate is released only after Day-90 evidence.	**Recommend** - keeps momentum, replaces the broken method.

The six signals, and what each one actually implies

Signal	What it tells us	What the recommendation does about it
Repository migration ahead of plan	The method works and the team can execute at pace	Continue it - do not disturb the one proven workstream
Pipeline conversion behind plan	Per-pipeline conversion cannot scale to 1,500 pipelines	Replace the method: reusable golden path plus migration factory
Security wants stronger enforcement	Controls are inconsistently applied across the estate	Enforce on all new work now; dated backlog for existing work
Legacy products cannot use standard runners	A genuine technical constraint, not a preference	Governed exception pools with owner and expiry - never a blanket exemption
Metric quality disputed	Definition and join disagreement, not missing volume	Freeze contested metrics; one definition, one owner, published exclusions
Developers report friction	The platform costs more effort than it returns today	Measure friction, reduce it with the golden path, and review with developers fortnightly

Pausing the whole transformation and pausing a single wave are different decisions. This paper recommends the second: pause only the wave that depends on disputed metrics or on runners that cannot meet the control baseline, and let the rest proceed.

What continues, what pauses, what is deferred

Continues	Pauses (wave-level only)	Deferred
Repository migration at current pace **Golden-path and reusable-workflow build** **Security baseline on all new work** **Metric reconciliation and friction telemetry**	The wave that depends on contested metrics The wave blocked by runners that cannot meet the control baseline Bulk conversion of unowned or dormant pipelines	Retiring Azure Boards Full ADO organisation decommissioning Autonomous production change Chargeback and multi-cloud standardisation

Security: tighten now, without unrecorded exceptions

Security's request is legitimate and should be granted on new work immediately. These five controls are non-waivable; an exception may change *which* check runs, never *whether* the decision is recorded.

- Every default branch protected by a reviewed ruleset with required checks.
- No long-lived credentials in pipelines; workload identity federation only.
- Secret scanning and push protection on; a detected secret is revoked, not just deleted.
- Third-party build steps pinned to full commit SHAs; dependency changes reviewed before merge.
- Production deployment carries an attributable human approval.

The three exceptions that need a decision, not a delay

Legacy runners	Not exempted from control - the control changes shape: one governed pool per real constraint, ephemeral images, restricted egress, identity federation, named owner, dated expiry. *Test: every legacy workload has an owner, an expiry and a passing security review.*
Disputed metrics	Freeze publication of contested metrics until one definition is signed by Data, Platform and Product; publish exclusions and a quality flag beside each number; reconcile old against new in writing. *Test: one definition, one owner, one number, with an audit trail.*
Developer friction	Measure before defending: time to first green, retry rate, abandonment, queue time, platform NPS - reviewed in a fortnightly developer council. *Test: friction falls while control coverage rises.*

Decisions required from executive stakeholders

#	Decision required	Owner	By	Consequence of delay
1	Adopt re-scope, not accelerate or pause	CTO	Day 5	Waves continue without evidence
2	Approve the controls and exception policy	CISO + CTO	Day 15	Security posture stays inconsistent
3	Authorise the metric freeze; name one owner	CTO + Product + Data	Day 20	Leadership keeps seeing disputed numbers
4	Fund the 90-day foundation and pilot	CTO + CFO	Day 10	No evidence exists for the Day-90 gate
5	Endorse legacy-runner model and funding	CISO + Product	Day 30	Runner sprawl becomes permanent
6	Confirm Azure Boards as system of record	Product	Day 30	Traceability design churns; scope reopens

Next checkpoint and the criteria to resume or accelerate

Day 90 decision gate. Resume the paused waves - and release full-estate funding - only when all four conditions hold. Accelerate only when they hold for two consecutive waves.

- Pilot services build, test, scan and deploy on the golden path, with controls evidenced end to end.
- Rollback has been rehearsed and timed on a real service.
- Metric definitions are signed, quality-flagged and reconciled in writing.
- Pilot teams recommend adoption, and time-to-first-green is under one hour.

If they fail, fix the path and re-test - do not pause the programme and do not widen it. Residual risks: throughput depends on seconded engineers, and enforcement without a fast exception route pushes delivery outside the platform.